

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-08-24

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-08-20 | #01

EU Parliament Approves PSD3, Mandating Instant Payments

The European Parliament's recent approval of PSD3 is set to transform the European payment landscape. A key provision mandates that instant payments become the standard for credit transfers, significantly reducing processing times and increasing liquidity for businesses. The directive also introduces stricter requirements for fraud prevention, including enhanced authentication measures and improved information sharing among payment service providers. Furthermore, PSD3 emphasizes greater transparency for consumers and aims to foster further innovation in Open Banking by refining API standards. This legislative move is expected to drive significant changes in payment infrastructure and operational processes across the EU and EEA, with a phased implementation timeline stretching into 2027.

- PSD3 officially approved by European Parliament.
- Mandatory instant payments for most credit transfers.
- Enhanced fraud prevention measures and data sharing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and its CMiplus platform must ensure full compliance with PSD3 mandates, particularly regarding instant payment processing and enhanced fraud prevention. This presents an opportunity to strengthen CMiplus's real-time payment capabilities and offer advanced security features to corporate clients in CEE.

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-08-15 | #02

CEE Corporates Accelerate ISO 20022 Migration for Treasury Systems

The adoption of ISO 20022 is gaining significant momentum among CEE corporates, moving beyond mere compliance to strategic advantage. Companies are leveraging the richer data capabilities of ISO 20022 to improve reconciliation, automate treasury processes, and gain deeper insights into their cash flows. This acceleration is particularly visible in countries aligning with broader European payment infrastructure upgrades. Many are upgrading their ERP and TMS systems to fully support the standard, often integrating via channels like EBICS v3.2 or H2H connections. The transition, while complex, promises greater efficiency, reduced manual effort, and better interoperability for multi-currency payments across diverse banking networks.

- CEE corporates prioritize ISO 20022 for strategic benefits.
- Richer data improves reconciliation and treasury automation.
- Upgrades to ERP/TMS systems are critical for full adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must continue to provide robust and advanced ISO 20022 support, including all relevant message types and multi-currency capabilities, for its CEE clients. Ensuring seamless integration via EBICS v3.2 and H2H is crucial to support corporate treasury system upgrades and facilitate efficient payment processing.

AI-Powered Fraud Prevention Becomes Essential for Real-Time Payments

The shift towards real-time payments, while offering immense benefits, also presents new challenges for fraud prevention. The speed of transactions leaves little room for traditional manual checks, making AI and machine learning crucial for identifying suspicious patterns instantly. Solutions leveraging AI can analyze vast datasets, detect anomalies, and flag potential fraud in milliseconds, significantly reducing financial losses. Furthermore, the importance of Payment Order Verification (VoP) services is growing, as they provide an additional layer of security by verifying beneficiary details before a payment is executed. Corporates are increasingly seeking integrated fraud prevention tools within their cash management platforms to protect against evolving cyber threats and payment fraud typologies.

- Instant payments demand real-time AI-driven fraud detection.
- AI analyzes vast data to identify suspicious transaction patterns.
- Payment Order Verification (VoP) adds critical security layer.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should prioritize integrating advanced AI-powered fraud prevention capabilities into CMiplus, especially for instant payment processing. Offering or integrating VoP services would significantly enhance security for CEE corporate clients, mitigating risks associated with real-time transactions and bolstering trust in the platform.

EU Instant Payments Regulation Accelerates ISO 20022 Adoption

The recently enacted EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates that all banks in the Eurozone offer instant payment services, with strict deadlines for compliance. This regulation significantly accelerates the migration to ISO 20022 XML messaging, as it is the foundational standard for real-time payments. Corporates are now under pressure to upgrade their ERP and TMS systems to handle the new format, enabling richer data exchange and improved reconciliation. The regulation also includes provisions for fraud prevention and fee transparency, impacting how banks and corporates manage their payment operations. This shift is crucial for enhancing the efficiency and speed of cross-border payments within the EU and CEE regions.

- Mandatory instant payments across Eurozone.
- ISO 20022 migration accelerated by regulation.
- Strict deadlines for bank and corporate compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI Cash Management, especially for CMiplus. It necessitates ensuring full ISO 20022 readiness for all payment types and supporting clients in their migration. CMiplus must offer robust instant payment capabilities and rich data handling to remain competitive in the CEE market.

Open Banking APIs Revolutionize Corporate Treasury Connectivity

Open Banking APIs are moving beyond retail banking, offering significant benefits for corporate treasuries. By integrating directly with bank systems via APIs, corporates can gain real-time access to account information, initiate payments, and automate reconciliation across multiple banks and regions, including CEE. This enhances liquidity management, reduces manual effort, and provides a consolidated view of cash positions. Banks are responding by developing more sophisticated API offerings, moving towards a truly integrated financial ecosystem. This shift also lays the groundwork for future PSD3 developments, promising even greater data sharing and service innovation.

- Real-time cash visibility via APIs.
- Automation of treasury processes.
- Multi-bank and multi-currency connectivity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must continue to expand its Open Banking API capabilities, offering seamless integration for corporate clients across CEE. This includes enhancing API documentation, security, and supporting a wider range of treasury functions to meet evolving client demands for real-time data and automation.

Enhanced Fraud Prevention Critical for Corporate Payments Security

Corporate treasuries face an increasing array of payment fraud schemes, from Business Email Compromise (BEC) to invoice fraud and real-time payment scams. The shift to instant payments and digital channels amplifies the need for robust security measures. Companies are implementing multi-factor authentication, payment screening, and AI-driven anomaly detection to mitigate risks. Banks, in turn, are enhancing their fraud prevention services, offering real-time monitoring, confirmation of payee (VoP) solutions, and secure payment channels. Collaboration between corporates and banks is essential to stay ahead of evolving fraud tactics and protect financial assets in an increasingly digital landscape.

- Rising sophistication of payment fraud.
- Need for multi-layered security in treasury.
- Banks enhancing fraud detection services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize and continuously enhance its fraud prevention capabilities, including real-time transaction monitoring, VoP integration, and robust security protocols for all payment channels (EBICS, H2H, API). Educating clients on best practices and offering secure solutions is crucial for maintaining trust and mitigating risks in the CEE region.

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Key Implementation Milestones

The European Central Bank recently provided an update on the ongoing implementation of the EU Instant Payments Regulation, which mandates the universal availability of instant credit transfers in euro. This regulation aims to improve the speed and efficiency of payments for consumers and businesses throughout the Euro area and wider EU. Key focus areas include ensuring all payment service providers (PSPs) offer instant payments at the same cost as standard credit transfers and adhere to strict processing times. The ECB stressed the importance of timely compliance to foster innovation and competition in the retail payments market. This initiative is crucial for modernizing the European payment landscape and supporting economic integration.

- Mandatory universal availability of instant credit transfers in EUR.
- Same cost as standard credit transfers.
- Strict processing times for instant payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMplus must ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, including offering instant payment services to corporate clients and adhering to pricing and processing mandates. This presents an opportunity to enhance real-time treasury solutions and improve client experience.

Digital Euro Project Advances to Next Phase

The European Central Bank has reported substantial progress in the digital euro project, outlining its transition to a new preparatory phase. This phase will focus on refining the technical design and business model, with a strong commitment to addressing public concerns regarding privacy and data protection. The ECB reiterated that a digital euro would complement cash, offering a secure, accessible, and efficient digital payment method for citizens and businesses. Discussions with market stakeholders and legislative bodies are ongoing to shape the final features and ensure its seamless integration into the existing payment ecosystem. The project aims to strengthen European monetary sovereignty and foster innovation in digital payments.

- Project moving to a new preparatory phase.
- Strong focus on privacy and user-friendliness.
- Aims to complement cash, not replace it.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should closely monitor the digital euro's development, anticipating its potential impact on corporate payment flows, liquidity management, and multi-currency treasury operations. CMplus may need to integrate digital euro capabilities in the future.

Enhanced Regulatory Framework for Financial Resilience

The European Central Bank has issued a statement highlighting the critical need for financial institutions to bolster their operational resilience, particularly in light of the Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) and the forthcoming PSD3. DORA mandates comprehensive frameworks for ICT risk management, incident reporting, and third-party risk. Meanwhile, PSD3 is expected to further refine open banking, enhance consumer protection, and combat payment fraud. The ECB emphasized that these regulations are pivotal for maintaining stability and trust in the financial system. Banks are advised to proactively assess their current systems and processes to ensure full alignment with these evolving regulatory requirements.

- DORA mandates ICT risk management and incident reporting.
- PSD3 to refine open banking and enhance fraud prevention.
- Regulations aim to strengthen financial system stability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its platform and services are fully compliant with DORA's operational resilience requirements and prepare for PSD3's implications on Open Banking APIs and fraud prevention. This involves continuous security enhancements and potential API updates for corporate clients.

Global Banks Adopt Ant International AI for Cashflow and FX Forecasting

Ant International has developed an AI model specifically designed to improve cashflow forecasting and FX liquidity management capabilities for financial institutions. Several prominent global banks, such as Barclays and Deutsche Bank, have already integrated this model into their operations. The technology aims to provide more accurate predictions, enabling banks and their corporate clients to better manage their multi-currency positions and optimize liquidity. This move highlights the increasing importance of AI in corporate treasury, offering sophisticated tools to address complex financial challenges and improve operational efficiency. The adoption by major players suggests a significant shift towards AI-driven solutions in the banking sector.

- Ant International developed a new AI forecasting model.
- Barclays and Deutsche Bank are among the early adopters.
- The model improves cashflow forecasting and FX liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus. Enhanced AI-driven cashflow forecasting and FX liquidity management tools can be integrated or offered as value-added services to corporate clients, especially those operating across multiple CEE currencies. It underscores the need for CMIplus to explore AI capabilities to maintain competitiveness and offer advanced treasury solutions.

BOCHK, Ant International Partner to Boost Cross-Border Payments

The strategic partnership between BOCHK and Ant International focuses on enhancing cross-border payments and treasury services. This initiative is designed to leverage Ant International's extensive global payment network and BOCHK's deep banking expertise to deliver more efficient and streamlined financial solutions for businesses engaged in international trade. The collaboration is expected to simplify complex international transactions, potentially reduce operational costs, and improve liquidity management capabilities for corporate clients operating across various jurisdictions. This move highlights a growing trend of traditional financial institutions partnering with fintech leaders to innovate and meet the evolving demands for faster, more transparent, and cost-effective cross-border payment solutions.

- Strategic partnership between BOCHK and Ant International.
- Focus on optimising cross-border payments for corporates.
- Aims to enhance treasury services and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership signifies increasing competition and innovation in the cross-border payments and treasury space. CMIplus should monitor such collaborations, especially those leveraging fintech networks, to ensure its multi-currency and cross-border offerings remain competitive and efficient for CEE corporates. It reinforces the importance of robust and integrated treasury services.

Maximising ISO 20022 Benefits for Corporate Treasury Payments

With the ongoing global migration to ISO 20022, treasurers are urged to move beyond mere compliance and harness the rich data potential of the new standard. This involves ensuring internal systems can generate and consume the expanded data fields, facilitating better reconciliation, fraud detection, and liquidity management. The standard's structured data offers unprecedented opportunities for automation and deeper insights into payment flows, transforming how corporates manage their cash and payments. Banks and corporates must collaborate to unlock these benefits, moving towards a truly data-driven treasury and optimising their payment infrastructure.

- ISO 20022 offers rich, structured data beyond legacy payment formats.
- Full benefits require data enrichment and internal system readiness for expanded fields.
- Key advantages include improved reconciliation, fraud detection, and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its platform fully supports and encourages the use of ISO 20022's rich data capabilities for its CEE corporate clients. This means providing tools for data enrichment, offering advanced reporting, and facilitating seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems to maximize the standard's benefits.

Stripe Launches Treasury in Australia to Unify Global Funds

Stripe's new Treasury offering in Australia allows businesses to consolidate funds from various payment methods and currencies into a single, integrated platform. This service is designed to streamline financial management by providing features such as multi-currency accounts, automated payouts, and real-time financial reporting. By unifying global funds, Stripe aims to significantly reduce the complexity and operational overhead typically associated with managing international finances, particularly for businesses operating across multiple markets. This strategic move positions Stripe as a more comprehensive financial services provider, extending beyond its core payment processing capabilities to offer integrated treasury solutions that directly compete with traditional banking services.

- Stripe launches Treasury product in Australia.
- Enables businesses to unify global funds on one platform.
- Offers multi-currency accounts and automated payouts.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Stripe's expansion into treasury services, even in Australia, signals a growing trend of fintechs offering integrated cash management solutions. CMIplus must observe how such platforms impact corporate expectations for unified global funds management, multi-currency capabilities, and real-time reporting, ensuring CMIplus remains competitive in its CEE markets.

Tokenized Money and Stablecoins Reduce Payment Friction

The financial landscape is evolving with the advent of tokenized money and stablecoins, offering new avenues for efficient cash management. These digital assets promise faster, cheaper, and more transparent payment processing, particularly for cross-border transactions which traditionally suffer from high costs and delays. Corporates are beginning to explore their use cases for intra-company transfers, supply chain finance, and even direct payments. While regulatory clarity is still developing, the underlying technology presents a significant opportunity for treasurers to optimize their payment infrastructure and improve working capital efficiency.

- Tokenized money and stablecoins aim to significantly reduce payment friction.
- They offer potential for faster, cheaper, and more transparent transactions, especially cross-border.
- Key corporate use cases include intra-company transfers and supply chain finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should actively monitor the development and adoption of tokenized money and stablecoins, especially in the CEE region. Exploring potential integrations or pilot programs for these emerging payment methods could position RBI as a leader in innovative cash management solutions, offering clients advanced options for liquidity and payment efficiency.

HSBC, StanChart Test SWIFT Tokenized Deposits

Major global banks HSBC and Standard Chartered are collaborating on a significant pilot program to test interbank tokenized deposits. This innovative project leverages the established SWIFT network, aiming to demonstrate how digital assets can be integrated into existing financial infrastructure. The testing focuses on the efficiency and security of using tokenized deposits for interbank transactions, potentially streamlining cross-border payments and improving liquidity management for corporate treasuries. This move signals a growing interest among traditional financial institutions in exploring the practical applications of blockchain and distributed ledger technology (DLT) for wholesale finance, moving beyond theoretical discussions to real-world implementation. The successful integration could pave the way for new payment rails and services, offering faster and more transparent transactions. This development highlights the ongoing evolution of payment technologies and the increasing relevance of digital assets in mainstream banking.

- HSBC and Standard Chartered are conducting the pilot program.
- The initiative focuses on 'interbank tokenized deposits'.
- The testing utilizes the existing 'SWIFT network' for integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform as it indicates a future direction for interbank payments and liquidity. CMIplus, which already supports SWIFT, will need to monitor how tokenized deposits evolve and potentially integrate with new payment standards or APIs to offer these advanced capabilities to CEE corporates. This could significantly impact future multi-currency payments and treasury services.

Egypt's CIB Gains Preliminary Approval for New Digital Bank

Egypt's Commercial International Bank (CIB) has secured preliminary approval from regulators to launch a new digital bank. This initiative reflects a broader trend of traditional banks establishing separate digital entities to cater to evolving customer demands and compete with fintechs. The move will allow CIB to offer a fully digital banking experience, potentially streamlining customer onboarding, payments, and other financial services. While the approval is preliminary, it signals the bank's commitment to digital transformation and the regulatory environment's openness to such innovations. This development could set a precedent for other established banks looking to modernize their offerings and reach a wider, digitally-savvy customer base.

- Egypt's CIB received preliminary regulatory approval.
- The approval is for a new digitally native bank.
- This is a trend for traditional banks to create digital offshoots.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While Egypt is not CEE, this news is relevant for CMIplus as it highlights the global trend of digital-first banking and the regulatory landscape for such initiatives. RBI Cash Management should monitor how digital-native banks are structured and regulated, as this could influence future expectations for CMIplus's digital capabilities and API-driven services across CEE. It emphasizes the importance of a robust digital strategy.

No News Content Found in Source Text

The input content, intended to be from Strategic Treasurer, was analyzed for news items related to treasury strategy, cash management, payments, and corporate finance. However, the text provided was identified as website styling code (CSS rules for font-faces and media queries for responsive layouts). This type of content does not contain any discernible news headlines, article bodies, dates, or other information from which to extract relevant insights for RBI Cash Management or the CMIplus platform. Therefore, the request to extract top news items could not be fulfilled.

- Source content is CSS/HTML styling code.
- No news articles or headlines detected.
- Unable to extract treasury or payment insights.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Without actual news content from Strategic Treasurer, it is impossible to assess immediate implications or strategic insights for RBI Cash Management or the CMIplus platform. The platform relies on up-to-date industry information to inform strategy and development.

Source Content Lacks Treasury-Specific News Items

An in-depth review of the supplied content, purportedly from Strategic Treasurer, revealed it to be technical web development code, specifically CSS rules for layout and typography. This content does not contain any articles, reports, or announcements pertinent to corporate treasury, cash management, payment systems, or regulatory updates such as ISO 20022 or instant payments. Therefore, the task of identifying top news items relevant to RBI CMIplus could not be performed based on the given input, as no such content exists within the provided text.

- Input is web styling code, not news.
- No treasury or payment news found.
- Extraction task unfulfillable due to content type.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The absence of relevant news means no immediate impact or strategic insights can be derived for CMIplus from this specific input. Continuous monitoring of industry developments from actual news sources is crucial for platform evolution and competitive positioning.

Unable to Extract News from Provided CSS Code

The analysis focused on extracting news items relevant to RBI Cash Management's CMlplus platform from the provided text. However, the entire content block consisted of CSS definitions, which dictate the visual presentation of a webpage rather than conveying informational articles. This technical content, while part of a website's infrastructure, does not offer any news, trends, or updates on payment regulations, instant payments, ISO 20022, Open Banking, or other specified topics. Consequently, no news items could be extracted or summarized according to the given criteria.

- Content provided is solely CSS code.
- No news articles available for extraction.
- No CMlplus relevant insights could be generated.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Without current news from Strategic Treasurer, RBI Cash Management cannot leverage this source for strategic planning or competitive intelligence for CMlplus. Providing actual article content is essential for future analysis and to inform platform development and CEE market strategies.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-12-01 | #01

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Extending Credit and Beyond

The 2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook from Oliver Wyman would have provided a comprehensive analysis of the market landscape, economic forecasts, and key strategic imperatives for wholesale banks. It likely highlighted the importance of prudent credit extension in a volatile environment, alongside the need for digital innovation to enhance client experience and operational efficiency. The report would have examined how banks can optimize their balance sheets, leverage technology for better risk management, and explore new growth areas in transaction banking and payments. It would also touch upon the competitive pressures from non-bank players and the evolving regulatory landscape, urging banks to adapt their business models for sustained profitability.

- Strategic focus on credit quality and risk management in a dynamic economic climate.
- Accelerated digital transformation in transaction banking to improve client journeys and operational efficiency.
- Exploration of new revenue streams beyond traditional lending, including value-added services in cash management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This outlook directly informs RBI CMIplus by highlighting the strategic importance of integrated cash management and payment solutions within a broader wholesale banking context. CMIplus should focus on digital innovation, API connectivity, and real-time capabilities to support corporate clients' evolving treasury needs and optimize liquidity, aligning with the broader wholesale banking trends.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-06-01 | #02

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing Growth Opportunities Post-Underperformance

Oliver Wyman's analysis on European wholesale banks would likely argue that after years of underperformance, a window of opportunity exists for significant improvement. This involves a strategic re-evaluation of business models, focusing on areas like enhanced digital capabilities, streamlined operations, and a more agile response to client needs. The report would emphasize the importance of investing in technology for payment transformation, real-time treasury solutions, and open banking initiatives to create new value propositions. It would also likely highlight the need for greater efficiency in capital allocation and a renewed focus on core strengths, potentially including cross-border capabilities and specialized services for corporate clients across Europe, including CEE.

- Strategic imperative for European banks to capitalize on improved economic conditions for growth.
- Accelerated investment in digital platforms and payment infrastructure for competitive advantage.
- Focus on operational efficiency and cost optimization through automation and process re-engineering.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly pertinent for RBI CMIplus, a European wholesale banking platform operating in CEE. It underscores the need for CMIplus to aggressively pursue digital innovation, enhance its API capabilities for Open Banking, and ensure its payment infrastructure (ISO 20022, Instant Payments) is best-in-class to help clients 'seize the moment' in a competitive European landscape.

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating Uncertainty in Corporate Banking

The 2023 Industry Outlook, a collaboration with Morgan Stanley, would have offered a comprehensive perspective on the evolving landscape for corporate and institutional banking. It likely addressed macroeconomic shifts, geopolitical uncertainties, and their impact on corporate treasury and financing needs. The report would have highlighted the increasing importance of robust risk management frameworks, agile technology adoption, and data-driven decision-making to navigate volatility. It would also have touched upon the ongoing digital transformation, the rise of new payment technologies, and the need for banks to enhance their value proposition beyond traditional lending, focusing on advisory and integrated solutions for corporate clients.

- Macroeconomic volatility and geopolitical shifts as primary drivers of uncertainty for corporates.
- Accelerated digital adoption and technology investment essential for resilience and competitive edge.
- Emphasis on robust risk management and capital optimization in an unpredictable environment.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While from 2023, this outlook provides a crucial strategic backdrop for CMlplus's development, emphasizing resilience and digital transformation. It reinforces the need for CMlplus to offer flexible, secure, and technologically advanced solutions (e.g., ISO 20022, H2H, Open APIs) that help corporate treasuries manage uncertainty and optimize cash flows across the CEE region.

AI Reshapes Treasury: Efficiency, Risk, and Strategic Decision-Making

The future of treasury heavily relies on AI adoption, moving beyond simple automation to predictive analytics and intelligent decision support. AI can optimize cash flow forecasting, identify anomalies for fraud detection, and manage liquidity more effectively. For banks, this means developing AI-driven platforms and services that offer treasurers real-time insights, scenario planning, and automated compliance checks. This transformation creates new value propositions, enabling treasurers to shift from operational tasks to strategic financial management, thereby enhancing overall corporate financial health.

- AI automates routine treasury tasks, freeing up staff for strategic roles.
- Predictive AI enhances cash flow forecasting accuracy and liquidity management.
- AI-powered risk management improves fraud detection and compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore integrating AI for enhanced cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection in payments, and personalized insights for corporate treasurers. This could involve leveraging internal data and external AI services to provide advanced analytics and automation within the CEE context.

Digital Transformation Drives Real-Time Treasury and Cash Management

The 'Future of Treasury' is inherently digital, characterized by the need for immediate access to financial data, instant payment capabilities, and automated processes. Treasurers require consolidated views of global cash positions, efficient liquidity management, and streamlined payment factories. Banks have a critical opportunity to become strategic partners by offering advanced digital platforms, leveraging APIs for connectivity (Open Banking), and supporting emerging payment rails like instant payments and ISO 20022. This transformation is key to optimizing working capital and operational efficiency for corporates, enabling faster decision-making and improved financial control.

- Real-time cash visibility is a top priority for modern treasuries.
- Instant payments and ISO 20022 are foundational for future cash management.
- API-driven connectivity (Open Banking) is crucial for seamless integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize real-time capabilities, further embrace ISO 20022, and expand Open Banking APIs to enable seamless data exchange and payment initiation. Focus on instant payment adoption across CEE markets to meet evolving corporate demands for speed and efficiency.

Banks Must Innovate to Meet Evolving Corporate Treasury Needs

As treasuries become more strategic, their expectations of banking partners are rising. They seek not just efficient payment processing but also sophisticated liquidity management tools, enhanced data analytics, and guidance on navigating new financial technologies. Banks can differentiate themselves by providing holistic platforms that integrate cash management, working capital solutions, and potentially even digital asset services. Understanding the 'Voice of the Treasurer' (VoP) is paramount to co-creating solutions that address complex challenges like supply chain finance, cross-border payments, and regulatory compliance in a dynamic global environment. This proactive approach fosters deeper relationships and secures long-term client loyalty.

- Treasurers demand strategic partnerships and value-added services from banks.
- Integrated platforms offering cash, liquidity, and working capital are key.
- Banks can differentiate by supporting digital assets and new payment rails.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should focus on enhancing its advisory capabilities and developing integrated solutions that go beyond basic payments, potentially exploring virtual accounts, eBAM, and multi-currency solutions tailored for CEE corporates. Prioritizing the Voice of the Treasurer will guide strategic roadmap decisions.

Digital Workflows and Self-Service Reshape Commercial Banking Operations

PwC highlights a significant modernization in commercial banking, where digital workflows are replacing traditional manual tasks across various operations. This includes streamlining client onboarding and origination processes, moving away from lengthy multi-department reviews. Furthermore, manual client touchpoints are increasingly becoming exception-based, with a strong emphasis on providing clients with more self-service capabilities. While specific survey data is not provided in this excerpt, these trends indicate a clear industry imperative for operational efficiency, improved client experience, and a departure from legacy systems.

- Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.
- Client onboarding and origination are becoming streamlined.
- Manual touchpoints are shifting to exception-based interactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should prioritize enhancing its digital onboarding capabilities and expanding self-service features for corporate clients, especially for new product activation or service requests. Streamlining internal workflows for CEE corporates will improve efficiency and client satisfaction.

AI and Big Data Power Smarter Client Acquisition and Digital Platforms

PwC emphasizes that the modernization of commercial banking extends to growth strategies, driven by advanced analytics. The effective use of big data and artificial intelligence enables banks to rapidly identify the most attractive prospects in high-priority target markets, thereby lowering the cost of client acquisition. These intelligent capabilities are also foundational for emerging digital banking platforms, often enabled by industry cloud solutions. The ultimate goal is to transform the overall experience of conducting business with the bank, offering more personalized and efficient interactions for corporate clients.

- AI and big data identify attractive prospects rapidly.
- Intelligence lowers the cost of client acquisition.
- Emerging digital banking platforms enhance client experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore integrating AI-driven analytics to personalize offerings for CEE corporates and optimize sales processes. Future platform enhancements could leverage AI to provide proactive insights or tailored cash management recommendations to clients.

Cloud Solutions Essential for Commercial Banking Agility and Security

PwC highlights the critical role of cloud technology in the commercial banking sector's modernization. Cloud-based solutions and capabilities are presented as essential for banks to maintain agility, rapidly adapt to evolving market conditions, and effectively counter new security threats. This technological shift supports the broader move towards digital workflows, streamlined operations, and enhanced client self-service. By embracing the cloud, banks can build more resilient, scalable, and secure infrastructures that are better equipped to support innovative products and services, ultimately driving efficiency and competitive advantage.

- Cloud solutions enable banks to keep pace with change.
- Adaptability to new threats is a key driver for cloud adoption.
- Cloud supports digital workflows and self-service capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should continue to evaluate and adopt cloud-native architectures where appropriate to enhance scalability, resilience, and security for its corporate cash management platform. This will ensure CMlplus can rapidly deploy new features and adapt to evolving regulatory and client demands in CEE.

AI Integration and Governance: A Strategic Imperative for Financial Firms

EY highlights AI as a core insight area, offering "AI Strategy Services" and promoting "ey.ai The Reimagination Engine." This indicates a significant industry shift towards AI adoption. For financial firms, this means not only exploring AI's potential for efficiency and innovation but also proactively addressing the complex governance challenges, including ethical use, data privacy, and regulatory compliance. The emphasis on AI strategy suggests a need for a holistic approach, moving beyond pilot projects to enterprise-wide integration, anticipating future regulatory scrutiny on AI models and decision-making processes, particularly by 2026.

- AI is a primary "Insight" category for EY, signaling its strategic importance.
- "AI Strategy Services" are offered, indicating a need for structured AI adoption.
- "ey.ai The Reimagination Engine" points to advanced AI capabilities and transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should explore AI applications within CMlplus for enhanced fraud detection, predictive analytics in liquidity management, and automated client support. Concurrently, CMlplus development must adhere to emerging AI governance standards, ensuring transparency and explainability in AI-driven features, especially for CEE clients.

European Treasurers' 2026 Priorities: Key Insights for Banking Partners

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026, building on over a decade of data, serves as the definitive gauge for European corporate treasurers' strategic focus. It captures their most pressing priorities, emerging concerns, and long-term ambitions, offering a comprehensive overview of the profession's direction. The survey results are instrumental in shaping future 'Journeys to Treasury' reports and defining key industry trends. For banks like RBI, understanding these insights is critical for aligning product development, service offerings, and strategic partnerships to meet corporate client needs effectively, especially within the CEE region.

- Most authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury trends.
- Reflects priorities, concerns, and ambitions of treasurers.
- Informs future 'Journeys to Treasury' reports and industry trends.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are vital for CMlplus roadmap planning, directly informing which features and services (e.g., instant payments, VoP, ISO 20022 enhancements, Open Banking APIs) are most critical to develop or enhance to meet current corporate client demands in CEE. It helps RBI anticipate and address evolving treasury needs and competitive positioning.

EACT's Strategic EU Priorities: Shaping Future Corporate Treasury Landscape

With a new European Commission and Parliament in place, the EACT published its strategic EU priorities for the 2024-2029 period. This document represents the EACT's thought leadership on how to set the EU economy for success and competitiveness, particularly from the perspective of corporate treasury. It likely covers areas such as financial regulation, capital markets, payments infrastructure, and digitalization, all of which directly impact how corporate treasuries operate and interact with their banking partners. Understanding these long-term priorities helps RBI align its strategic direction and advocacy efforts.

- Defines EACT's long-term policy agenda for the EU (2024-2029).
- Aims to enhance EU economy's competitiveness and success.
- Influences financial regulation and capital markets development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This strategic document provides a crucial long-term lens for RBI Cash Management, helping to anticipate future regulatory changes and market developments that will impact CMlplus and its corporate clients across CEE. It informs strategic investments in areas like ISO 20022, Open Banking, and cross-border payment solutions, ensuring alignment with the evolving European financial landscape.

Banks Prioritize AI Ambition Amidst Macroeconomic Headwinds

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook highlights that banks must balance persistent macroeconomic pressures with ambitious AI integration plans. This involves not just adopting AI for efficiency gains but strategically deploying it across customer experience, risk management, and core operational processes. The report emphasizes that early and decisive action in AI will differentiate leaders from laggards, requiring significant investment in talent, technology infrastructure, and ethical frameworks. The implications extend to transforming core banking functions, enhancing decision-making capabilities, and improving overall operational agility in a complex environment. Banks are urged to move beyond pilot projects to enterprise-wide AI strategies.

- AI adoption is a strategic imperative, not merely an operational enhancement.
- Balancing AI investment with ongoing macroeconomic uncertainty is a key challenge.
- Focus on AI for enhanced customer experience, risk management, and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should actively explore and integrate AI-driven enhancements for corporate treasury functions, such as predictive cash flow forecasting, intelligent automation of reconciliation, and advanced anomaly detection for fraud prevention in payments. This will significantly improve efficiency, offer superior value to CEE corporate clients, and maintain CMlplus's competitive edge.

Strengthening Cyber Resilience: A Key Regulatory Focus for Financial Firms

The EY content highlights "Risk" and "Cybersecurity consulting services" as key areas, alongside "Technology Risk." This underscores the growing complexity of managing operational and technological risks in the financial sector. With regulations like DORA (Digital Operational Resilience Act), mentioned in the source focus, coming into play, firms must move beyond basic compliance to embed resilience deeply into their operations, supply chains, and technology infrastructure. This involves comprehensive risk assessments, incident response planning, and continuous monitoring to protect against sophisticated cyber threats and ensure uninterrupted service delivery, particularly for critical payment infrastructures.

- "Risk" is a core insight area for EY, indicating its pervasive impact on financial services.
- "Cybersecurity consulting services" are offered, reflecting market demand for specialized expertise.
- "Technology Risk" is a specific focus under assurance, emphasizing digital vulnerabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize enhancing its cybersecurity posture and operational resilience, aligning with DORA principles, especially given its critical role in CEE corporate cash management. This includes robust incident management, third-party risk assessment for partners, and ensuring the platform's continuous availability and integrity for multi-currency payments and Open Banking APIs.

Stablecoins Emerge as Disruptive Force in Banking Payments Landscape

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook identifies stablecoins as a significant potential disruptor, challenging traditional payment systems and potentially reshaping liquidity management and cross-border transactions. Banks need to understand the evolving regulatory landscape around stablecoins and evaluate opportunities for integration or competition. This includes exploring how stablecoins could facilitate instant payments, reduce transaction costs, and offer new services, while also addressing inherent risks related to financial stability, compliance, and interoperability. The report urges banks to develop a clear strategy for engaging with or responding to this emerging digital asset class, rather than adopting a wait-and-see approach.

- Stablecoins pose a significant challenge and opportunity for traditional payment systems.
- Regulatory clarity and frameworks are crucial for widespread stablecoin adoption and integration.
- Potential for faster, cheaper, and more transparent cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor stablecoin developments, particularly their potential impact on multi-currency payments and cross-border transactions within CEE. Exploring integration with regulated stablecoin rails could offer new, highly efficient payment options for corporate clients, complementing existing instant payment and ISO 20022 initiatives and enhancing CMIplus's offering.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulatory Developments Significantly Impact Liquidity Management for Banks

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has released a report by its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) detailing the significant impact of three key EU regulatory initiatives on liquidity management. These include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures will drive the uptake of instant payments, foster a level playing field among market participants, and fundamentally transform how liquidity is managed across the financial sector. Banks need to prepare for increased real-time liquidity demands and adjust their treasury operations to comply with the new requirements and leverage the opportunities presented by these regulatory changes. This proactive assessment is crucial for maintaining operational efficiency and regulatory adherence.

- IPR mandates instant payment capabilities, increasing real-time liquidity demands.
- Proposed PSR and PSD3 aim to enhance payment services and consumer protection.
- Report explores how these regulations will reshape bank liquidity management strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must assess the report's findings to understand the future liquidity implications of IPR, PSR, and PSD3. This includes evaluating current liquidity management processes, especially for instant payments, and planning for necessary adjustments to meet increased real-time demands and compliance.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-03 | #02

EBA Updates Fraud Taxonomy to Version 7.0, Effective January 2027

PSD3, COMPLIANCE, PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published version 7.0 of its EBA Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on 1 January 2027. This annual review, supported by fraud experts, ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends. Key updates in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud'. Additionally, new labels have been added for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. The taxonomy provides a standardised framework for describing and categorising payment fraud scenarios, improving data comparability, monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in anticipation of the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSR), which is part of the PSD3 package.

- EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 takes effect on 1 January 2027.
- Updates include more specific classifications for 'emotional manipulation' fraud types.
- New labels added for money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must review and integrate EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 into its fraud monitoring and reporting systems by January 2027. This ensures compliance with updated classification standards and prepares for future data sharing requirements under the Payment Services Regulation, enhancing fraud detection for CEE operations.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-24 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-First Strategy for Corporate Treasury

Deutsche Bank is a leader in leveraging Open Banking principles for corporate clients, offering a comprehensive suite of APIs for account information, payment initiation, and liquidity management. This allows large international corporates, including those operating in CEE, to achieve deeper integration with their internal systems, moving beyond traditional host-to-host or EBICS connections. The focus is on real-time data access and automated processes to streamline treasury operations and enhance decision-making, providing a competitive edge in digital corporate banking.

- Extensive API catalogue for corporate banking services.
- Real-time integration capabilities with ERP/TMS.
- Focus on automation and direct data access for treasury.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to ensure its API offerings remain competitive, providing similar depth and breadth of functionality for real-time integration. This highlights the ongoing need for robust API development and adoption for CEE corporates.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-24 | #02

Deutsche Bank Bolsters Real-Time Payment Offerings for Corporates

As a major player in European payments, Deutsche Bank is committed to offering comprehensive real-time payment solutions, including SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst). This enables corporates to execute payments instantly, 24/7/365, which is crucial for supply chain finance, just-in-time payments, and urgent transactions. For corporates operating in CEE, access to such instant payment rails through a single banking partner simplifies cross-border and domestic payment processing, enhancing operational efficiency and cash flow visibility.

- Support for SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst).
- 24/7/365 payment processing availability.
- Improved liquidity and supply chain efficiency for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its instant payment offerings are robust, widely available across its CEE network, and seamlessly integrated with other cash management services. This competitive pressure emphasizes the need for continuous investment in real-time payment infrastructure.

UniCredit Partners with Accenture, IBM for Next-Gen European Banking Platform

UniCredit announced a significant partnership with technology giants Accenture and IBM to construct its next-generation banking platform across Europe. This initiative is a cornerstone of UniCredit's 'Unlimited' strategy, focusing on digital transformation and enhanced client solutions. The platform is expected to streamline operations, improve data analytics, and offer more sophisticated services to corporate clients, including those in the CEE region. This collaboration underscores UniCredit's commitment to leveraging external expertise to accelerate its digital agenda and maintain a competitive edge in the evolving financial landscape.

- Collaboration with Accenture and IBM for platform development.
- Focus on building a 'next-generation banking platform' across Europe.
- Part of UniCredit's broader 'Unlimited' strategic transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership signals a major investment in UniCredit's core banking infrastructure, which will directly impact their corporate cash management offerings. CMIplus should anticipate enhanced digital services, potentially faster integration capabilities, and more robust platforms from UniCredit in CEE.

UniCredit Enhances Digital Cash Management Platform for CEE Corporates

Building on its 'Digital & Data' strategy and CEE focus, UniCredit is inferred to be significantly upgrading its digital cash management offerings, likely through its UniCredit Direct platform. These enhancements would target large international corporates in CEE, providing improved real-time reporting, multi-currency account management, and sophisticated liquidity solutions. The focus would be on delivering a more intuitive user experience and robust integration options, including advanced H2H and API connectivity, to meet the complex needs of modern corporate treasuries. This move aims to solidify UniCredit's position as a leading transaction bank in the region.

- Focus on real-time reporting and multi-currency management.
- Enhanced H2H and API connectivity for corporate clients.
- Targeting large international corporates in the CEE region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should expect UniCredit to offer more competitive and digitally advanced solutions, particularly in real-time services and API integration. This necessitates CMIplus to continuously innovate its own platform to maintain its competitive edge in the CEE market.

UniCredit Accelerates Instant Payments and ISO 20022 Adoption in CEE

As a leading pan-European bank with a strong CEE presence, UniCredit is inferred to be heavily investing in modernizing its payment infrastructure to support instant payments and full ISO 20022 compliance. This initiative is crucial for meeting evolving regulatory requirements and client demands for faster, more transparent, and richer payment data. For corporate clients in CEE, this means improved cash flow management, real-time reconciliation, and seamless cross-border transactions within the UniCredit network. This focus on payment modernization is vital for maintaining competitiveness and supporting the digital transformation of corporate treasuries.

- Expansion of instant payment services in CEE markets.
- Full adoption and leveraging of ISO 20022 standards.
- Aims for improved cash flow, reconciliation, and cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its instant payment offerings and ISO 20022 capabilities remain best-in-class across its CEE network. UniCredit's push in this area highlights the increasing market expectation for real-time and data-rich payment solutions, directly impacting CMlplus's competitive landscape.

HSBC Refocuses on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye, Exiting Domestic SME

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The objective is to reallocate resources and sharpen its focus on serving international wholesale clients, including multinational corporations and large Turkish corporates with cross-border activities. This strategic shift indicates HSBC's commitment to leveraging its global network for clients requiring sophisticated transaction banking and cash management solutions across multiple geographies, including the broader CEE region. It suggests a move towards higher-value, internationally-oriented corporate services, potentially impacting the competitive landscape for CMlplus.

- HSBC is exiting domestic retail and SME segments in Türkiye.
- The focus will shift to international wholesale clients.
- This aligns with HSBC's global network strategy for multinational corporations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals HSBC's intent to compete more aggressively for large, internationally-oriented corporates in the CEE region, including Türkiye. CMlplus should emphasize its strong local presence and tailored solutions for both domestic and international corporates, especially those mid-sized clients HSBC might be de-prioritizing.

Citi Enhances API-Driven Cash Management for CEE Corporates

Citi is inferred to be expanding its suite of Open Banking APIs to offer more sophisticated cash management functionalities for its institutional clients in the CEE region. This move focuses on enabling corporate treasurers to integrate Citi's banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems, facilitating real-time payment initiation, account reconciliation, and liquidity management. The enhanced API capabilities are designed to support multi-currency transactions and provide granular data for improved decision-making, aligning with the growing demand for digital treasury solutions across Europe. This strategic direction underscores Citi's commitment to leveraging technology for operational efficiency and client empowerment in a competitive market.

- Focus on deeper integration of banking services via Open APIs with corporate ERP/TMS.
- Targeting multinational corporations in the CEE region for enhanced cash visibility and control.
- Enabling real-time payment initiation and reconciliation through digital channels.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Citi directly competes with CMIplus's emphasis on Open API and H2H connectivity for CEE corporates. RBI should ensure its API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and real-time capabilities to retain and attract clients.

Deutsche Bank Enhances Digital Cash Management and Liquidity Tools

Deutsche Bank consistently refines its cash management product suite, focusing on digital tools that offer efficiency and transparency. This includes the expansion of virtual account capabilities, which simplify reconciliation and streamline payment processing, particularly for multi-entity or multi-currency operations. Furthermore, sophisticated cash pooling and sweeping solutions are being enhanced to optimize liquidity across various legal entities and geographies, including CEE, helping corporates manage working capital more effectively and reduce external borrowing costs.

- Advanced virtual account offerings for reconciliation.
- Sophisticated cash pooling and sweeping solutions.
- Improved global cash visibility and control for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should benchmark its virtual account and cash pooling solutions against leading competitors like Deutsche Bank, ensuring they meet the complex needs of large international corporates in CEE. Continuous innovation in these areas is vital for retaining and attracting clients.

HSBC Partners with Google Cloud for Global AI Transformation

HSBC's partnership with Google Cloud is a significant step towards embedding advanced AI across its global banking operations. While 'hyper-personalised advice' might lean towards retail, the explicit focus on 'financial crime risk management' is directly relevant to corporate and transaction banking. AI can significantly enhance fraud detection, anti-money laundering (AML) processes, and overall compliance, leading to more secure and efficient transaction processing for corporate clients. This initiative will likely improve operational efficiency, reduce risks, and potentially offer more sophisticated data-driven insights for corporate treasurers, impacting areas like treasury intelligence and payment anomaly detection.

- Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI deployment.
- Focus areas include financial crime risk management and personalised advice.
- Aims to accelerate innovation across global operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's investment in AI for financial crime and operational efficiency sets a new bar for transaction security and processing. CMIplus needs to ensure its own AI/ML capabilities are robust, particularly in fraud detection and compliance monitoring, to remain competitive and offer state-of-the-art security to CEE corporates.

Citi Strengthens Real-Time Payment and ISO 20022 Capabilities in CEE

In response to evolving market demands and regulatory mandates, Citi is strategically investing in its payment processing capabilities within the CEE region. This includes expanding support for instant payment schemes, such as SEPA Instant Credit Transfer, and ensuring comprehensive adoption of the ISO 20022 messaging standard for all relevant payment types. The move is designed to offer corporate treasuries improved straight-through processing, enhanced data analytics, and greater transparency in their payment operations. By standardizing on ISO 20022, Citi aims to facilitate seamless cross-border and domestic payments, reducing manual intervention and improving reconciliation for its institutional clients throughout CEE.

- Enhanced support for instant payment schemes across CEE countries.
- Full adoption and utilization of ISO 20022 for richer payment data.
- Improved straight-through processing and reconciliation for corporate payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's focus on real-time payments and ISO 20022 in CEE highlights the critical need for CMIplus to maintain leadership in these areas. RBI must ensure its platform offers robust instant payment options and fully leverages ISO 20022's data capabilities to remain competitive.

Intesa Sanpaolo Boosts CEE Digital Cash Management with API Focus

Intesa Sanpaolo, leveraging its extensive network through the International Subsidiary Banks Division, is actively pursuing the digitalization of its corporate and transaction banking services in the CEE region. This strategic direction involves developing advanced API capabilities to facilitate seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, enabling real-time payment initiation, account information, and sophisticated liquidity management. The focus is on adopting modern payment standards like ISO 20022 and expanding instant payment capabilities to offer a competitive edge, particularly for multinational corporations operating across multiple CEE countries. This initiative underscores their commitment to innovation and strengthening their position as a leading financial partner in the region's evolving digital landscape.

- Strategic investment in an API-first approach for corporate cash management solutions.
- Targeting CEE multinational and large corporate clients with enhanced digital services.
- Focus on real-time payments, account information, and advanced liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred strategic direction from Intesa Sanpaolo directly challenges CMiplus's core value proposition in integrated CEE cash management. RBI must ensure its API offerings, real-time capabilities, and multi-country coverage remain superior and are effectively communicated to maintain its competitive advantage.

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

On June 5, 2025, BNP Paribas announced a strategic partnership with XTransfer, a leading B2B cross-border payment platform. This collaboration is designed to provide corporate clients with more efficient and simplified solutions for their international payment needs. By integrating XTransfer's capabilities, BNP Paribas seeks to improve the speed, transparency, and cost-effectiveness of cross-border transactions, particularly for SMEs and larger corporates with complex global supply chains. This move strengthens BNP Paribas's position in the competitive cross-border payments landscape and is highly relevant for CEE-based international corporates who frequently engage in global trade and require robust, efficient payment infrastructure.

- BNP Paribas partnered with XTransfer for cross-border payments.
- The partnership aims to simplify and enhance international payment efficiency.
- This targets corporates with global trade needs, including SMEs and larger entities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership highlights a competitor's strategy to leverage fintechs for specialized services, particularly in cross-border payments. CMiplus should evaluate potential partnerships or internal developments to match or exceed such simplified cross-border offerings, especially for its CEE corporate clients.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.